



INDIEFFERENTIAL

WHAT'S NEW?

by **indiefferential**

TIA BRITTANY | SEPTEMBER VOL .2 2026

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WELCOME TO INDIEFFERENTIAL

Do you remember that time you discovered your favorite band? What was that like? How did it feel? Over the years we have found different ways of discovering new music and other formats of entertainment. Some of you already remember the first time you bought a vinyl record or a CD.

For me, it was one of the best experiences when I bought an AC/DC CD freshly bought ready to be played at full volume in my parent's Hi-Fi system. The physical aspect of the release always was something that stayed with me for a long time and I loved the whole experience of having that CD, inserting it into the system, controlling the volume and listening to my favorite tracks over and over again. Everything that came along with the CD was a bonus, you could look at pictures, read about the band and have something to do while experiencing their music.

Right now most music is released in digital formats and you can't really experience this. Magazines were also something that introduced me to my favorite bands back in the day. I remember reading about the Killers long before listening to their hits on the radio. Still, the physical aspect of the discovery was significant, for me at least. Of course, it's a lot easier to find out great music these days and not buy seven different CDs to discover what you like.

Enough with the past though, let's move to today, you can stream music, films and series and many people don't bother buying magazines or CDs. I am one of these people who loves to collect things and I also own many video games in digital and physical format. Even though some of my favorite video games are in a library on my computer, I always cherish the time I take to look through the case of an older video game, its pamphlets and artwork.

This is one of the reasons we started Indiefferential. The experience of holding a physical magazine in your hands, reading about these new bands from the other side of the world while you listen to their music online sending them a DM that you love their work. This is what Indiefferential is all about, keeping the good aspects of physical releases and combining this experience with the modern opportunities technology provides.

Indiefferential is here for every artist out there, we love what we do and we will keep posting about your music and projects so people can find out their new favorite artist. Our plan is to post consistently about new artists and creators, in that way, your audience will find out about another great band and their audience will discover your work. This is how Indiefferential works, always supporting artists in order to find the right audience and have their work sent across the whole world.

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George Skandros

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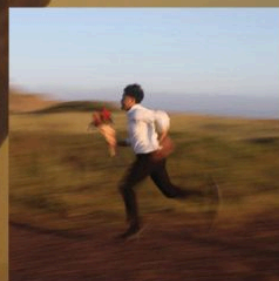
DI Matrix turns a lost chapter into a dancefloor comeback

DI Matrix has spent nearly four decades carrying the memory of an underground classic, and his return to music feels less like nostalgia than a continuation of unfinished business. His 1986 release, "Feel My Bass", became a staple of breasted culture, earning an enduring following while Matrix was serving in the US Marines. The Gulf War soon interrupted his musical career, leaving the artist away from the spotlight for decades.

That changed when Egyptian Lover tracked him down and encouraged a return, resulting in "Eppurte" in 2003. A collaboration with Heat Funks founder Race followed with "Feel My Bass (Reloaded)", giving the signature track a new lease on life while reconnecting Matrix with the audience that had never forgotten it.

Now comes "Heat Check", a more contemporary dancefloor statement that carries the confidence of an artist rediscovering his momentum. Matrix's electronic approach remains rooted in rhythm and physical energy, but the production reflects a willingness to move forward rather than simply recreate the past.

With plans for monthly singles leading toward a full album, Matrix is turning an unexpected second act into a sustained creative run. "Heat Check" captures that renewed purpose, bringing a veteran of early electronic culture back into the present with plenty of energy left to spend.



KINO CALMOG finds quiet beauty in the art of letting go

KINO CALMOG explores heartbreak through a sound that sits comfortably between indie pop, neo soul, and intimate singer songwriter music. With warm acoustic textures, soulful vocals, and reflective writing, Calmog creates songs that treat romance and emotional charge with honesty rather than melodrama.

"If I Die" opens a new chapter in that journey, focusing on the difficult acceptance that comes when someone you once imagined a future with is no longer part of it. The song carries the weight of deep attachment while gradually moving toward release, finding tenderness in the realization that letting go can also be an act of self preservation.

Influences from Daniel Caesar, Frank Ocean, and Bruno Major can be felt in the track's restrained emotional delivery and understated warmth, but Calmog's approach remains personal. The production leaves space around the vocal, allowing the lyrics and subtle instrumental details to carry the emotional narrative.

Rather than presenting heartbreak as a single moment, "If I Die" captures the slower process of understanding, accepting, and rebuilding. It introduces an artist interested in the complicated space between love and loss, setting the tone for a broader musical journey about healing, self discovery, and finding yourself again.



EPIC NELSON chase endless summer with Beach Fever

EPIC NELSON lean into the brighter side of rock and roll with "Beach Fever", a spirited summer track built around soaring vocals, ringing guitar lines, and hooks that aim straight for the singalong instinct. The Bay Area band's latest release embraces the larger than life character of 1980s arena rock while keeping its blues rock foundation and modern melodic sensibility intact.

At the heart of the song is a simple fantasy, escaping routine, gathering the people you love, and finding somewhere warm enough to forge the clock that carries the idea shapes the music itself, with vibrant harmonies and energetic guitar work creating the sensation of open roads, ocean air, and long evenings without an agenda.

Eric Nelson's vocals give the track its celebratory center, while the guitars provide much of its heat, moving between muscular riffs and expressive solos. Rather than treating nostalgia as a museum piece, EPIC NELSON use the sounds of classic arena rock as a launchpad for something deliberately joyful and immediate.

"Beach Fever" captures the band's instinct for music that brings people together. It is upbeat without losing its rock edge, polished enough for the studio but clearly built with the live stage in mind. For EPIC NELSON, summer becomes more than a setting, it becomes a state of mind.

GUYVER7X3: THE ARTIST CRAFTING EMOTION IN EVERY NOTE



In a world where music often feels like a straightforward means of communication, Guyver7x3 stands out with his work. Known for crafting an emotional landscape that is as complex and nuanced as the human experience itself, he defies genre boundaries to create music from within.

"Slowly Ready," the latest track from Guyver7x3, captures a moment of profound growth, when someone acknowledges their journey without feeling stuck or delayed. The song encapsulates a quiet yet impactful realization: there is no need to rush through emotions to progress; sometimes, simply moving forward is enough.

Guyver7x3's work is characterized by emotional behavior rather than static genre definitions. Each song can shift from alternative R&B to cinematic pop, electronic pressure, spoken cognition, hip-hop, or distorted rock, always guided by the underlying emotion of what he's trying to communicate. This approach creates a fluid and

expansive listening experience where every production decision is deliberate.

For Guyver7x3, vulnerability doesn't mean simplifying experiences for broader appeal; instead, it means preserving them in a way that listeners can relate to. His songs often begin with his own personal stories but open up enough to allow other emotions and experiences to enter the space.

He views technology not as a replacement for identity but as an additional tool for translation, enabling him to convey complex feelings more effectively. This includes developing evolving creative systems designed to protect emotional continuity, vocal character, psychological intent, and the authenticity of his performances.

Guyver7x3's innovation lies in finding new ways to communicate what ordinary language fails to capture. His music navigates through abandonment, self-recognition, memory,

emotional survival, fractured relationships, internal conflict, and the process of becoming visible to oneself. Each song exists as a microcosm, allowing listeners to feel inside the feeling itself.

What sets Guyver7x3 apart is his commitment to not merely following trends but rather creating a language for emotions that have yet to find expression through music. His work often feels personal without falling into the trap of being overly intimate or closed off; it remains open and engaging, inviting listeners into its emotional environments.

In an age where many musicians seek to simplify their artistry to reach broader audiences, Guyver7x3 chooses to deepen his craft with each new song. Through "Slowly Ready" and beyond, he continues to build a language that bridges the gap between vulnerability and understanding, offering a space for listeners to find themselves within his creations.



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THE ELECTRIC FUSION OF DREAMS: MEET KAI MOA

One producer stands out as a fusion artist par excellence. Enter Kai Moa, an innovative producer from Birmingham, UK, who has been quietly building his reputation through a series of standout singles. Now, he's set to unveil his debut EP, "Some of My Best Friends Are...Electric Sheep," promising listeners an immersive journey into the eclectic landscape of modern electronic music.

Kai Moa's artistic identity is rooted in a unique blend of influences that span from IDM and AltPop to Ambient, Industrial, and Dubstep. This melange creates a sonic canvas where every track feels like it could be the next chapter in a vast tapestry of genres. The EP title itself, "Some of My Best Friends Are...Electric Sheep", is both enigmatic and inviting, hinting at the rich tapestry of sounds that await within.

The first single from "Some of My Best Friends Are...Electric Sheep," released exclusively to fans via his Bandcamp page, is a standout entry. Opening with an industrial soundscape reminiscent of futuristic dystopia, it seamlessly transitions into cosmic jazz, a moment where Kai Moa's creative vision comes alive on the listener's ears. This track not only showcases the producer's ability to blend

diverse sonic elements but also hints at what listeners can expect from the EP as a whole.

THE STORY

Kai Moa's live performances are equally captivating and showcase his mastery of improvisation. With each show, he builds upon these foundational tracks, adding layers that highlight his versatility and depth. His career in traditional music forms like jazz ensembles and post-rock groups has undoubtedly shaped his approach to electronic production, allowing him to bring a fresh perspective to this genre.

The EP's standout track is not just an auditory journey but also a testament to Kai Moa's creative vision. The fusion of multiple genres creates a sonic landscape that feels both familiar yet unexplored. It's like entering a club where everything seems new and exciting, yet you recognize certain motifs from the jazz and classical music he's influenced by.

Kai Moa's debut EP is more than just a collection of tracks; it's an experience designed to engage listeners on multiple levels. From the industrial soundscape that sets the stage for cosmic

exploration, to the psychedelic jazz chords that evoke memories of earlier eras, each element contributes to a rich tapestry that reflects Kai Moa's expansive creative vision.

With live performances and potential tours in the pipeline, fans will have ample opportunity to witness these tracks come to life. "Some of My Best Friends Are...Electric Sheep" promises not just another EP but an immersive experience that bridges different genres and eras through a single artist's lens.

For those eager to dive into Kai Moa's unique world, check out his latest release on Bandcamp. The journey begins now, with the promise of endless sonic adventures ahead.



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"THE GLIMMER AND THE GRAY: THE LEMON GROVE'S MELODIC MAELSTROM"

Hidden beneath the polished veneer of downtown Helsinki's café culture lies "The Lemon Grove," a musical duo whose music defies easy categorization. Their new track, "Paper Hearts," paints a vivid picture of two hearts entangled in an intricate dance with reality itself.

"The Paper Hearts" is more than just a song, it's a sonic exploration of emotional depths that are both familiar and foreign. The track captures the poignant blend of longing, resilience, and the often elusive quest for clarity that defines many love stories. This piece from "The Lemon Grove" encapsulates these emotions through its layered production, oscillating between intimate closeness and distant melancholy.

Born from the fertile soil of Helsinki's creative community, The Lemon Grove is a marriage of artistic pursuits. Two psychologists with a shared passion for music have come together to forge their unique sound. Their influences range widely, think Lana Del Rey's ethereal melodies, Adele's raw emotional depth, and perhaps even a nod towards Fleetwood Mac for its timeless harmony.

The production quality on "Paper Hearts" is nothing short of exquisite. It begins with the tenderest whispers that soon give way to expansive choruses, each crescendo carrying with it layers of sonic texture. The transition from soft piano chords to cascading strings creates an immersive experience where every sound feels like a carefully crafted detail.

The lyrics of "Paper Hearts" are not just words, they are stepping stones on an emotional journey that listeners can follow. Each line is imbued with the weight of human emotion, touching upon themes such as duality, both embracing and rejecting aspects of oneself, and internal conflict, struggling to reconcile inner turmoil with outward expressions.

In interviews, band members often speak about how their backgrounds in psychology have influenced the way they approach songwriting. This insight into their creative process underscores why The Lemon Grove's music feels so deeply resonant: it speaks directly to listeners' experiences and emotions without ever feeling preachy or heavy-handed.

"Two psychologists with a shared passion for music have come together to forge their unique sound."

While "Paper Hearts" delves deep into heartache, there is a sense of hope in its production too. It's not merely the absence of darkness that makes this track stand out; it's how the moments of brightness and resilience are woven into the tapestry of sorrow. This interplay between light and shadow creates an emotional landscape that feels both intimate and expansive.

As they continue to evolve their sound, "The Lemon Grove" shows no signs of resting on laurels. Their latest project hints at even greater creative heights yet to be reached. With each new piece, we are invited into a world where the boundaries between reality and fiction blur like never before.

In their music, they offer not just escapist fantasies but genuine reflections of human experience. For fans seeking something more than simple melodrama or surface-level sentimentality, "The Lemon Grove" provides a singularly rich auditory experience that invites listeners to dive into its emotional depth.



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Grey Notes: The Melodic Maelstrom of Love's Uncertainty

With her latest single, "Grey," singer-songwriter Beth Sarah has once again delved into the intricate tapestry of loveged emotions. This time around, she confronts a particularly tender and elusive territory, uncertainty in the realm of loveged. In an effort to capture this liminal state, Beth is launching a campaign called Beautifully Unfinished, inviting listeners on a journey through the creative process behind each song.

Beth Sarah's music has been a consistent source of emotional honesty since her debut single "Rollerskates" in 2020. Her latest efforts, culminating in the upcoming album *Almost*, have cemented her position as an artist who dares to explore deep personal experiences through her art. Let's delve into what makes Beth Sarah's music so compelling and how she has evolved with each release.

Beth Sarah first gained attention as a solo artist with "Rollerskates" in 2020, which resonated deeply within local audiences. This track marked the beginning of her journey, where she began to carve out her own unique sound and identity. Her debut album, *Let Her Go* (2023), was an extension of this burgeoning voice; it explored themes of growth, trauma, and self-discovery with a raw authenticity that endeared her to listeners.

One standout track from "Let Her Go" is "Thunderstorm," which showcases Beth's knack for crafting melodies that are both memorable and poignant. Songs like "You're In My Head" and "Not Today" have also earned widespread acclaim for their emotional resonance, making them fan favorites. These tracks demonstrate the depth of her songwriting, a gift for pairing catchy hooks with lyrics that offer solace, strength, and reflection.

While Beth Sarah's recorded output is compelling, her live performances elevate her work to new heights. The singer has been a fixture at venues and festivals across the South East region since 2021, including Piano Smithfield, The Dublin Castle, and The Factory Live. Her ability to connect with audiences on a personal level is undeniable; whether performing solo or alongside a band, Beth's warmth and authenticity create an environment where genuine connections are fostered.

One of her most memorable performances came during the 2023 Hastings Fat Tuesday Festival when

she supported KT Tunstall. Her raw talent and emotionally charged delivery made for unforgettable moments that underscored her status as one of the region's rising stars. Beth's live shows embody a commitment to artistic authenticity, reflecting a performer who is not only skilled but also deeply committed to engaging with her audience.

The latest chapter in Beth Sarah's journey comes through her Beautifully Unfinished campaign for "Grey," where she invites listeners into the creative process of her work. This initiative serves as a testament to her openness and willingness to share her artistic journey, offering an intimate look at how she turns personal experiences into cathartic music.

Her most recent release, the EP *Catharsis* (2025), was not only critically acclaimed but also earned her a win in the Best Album category of the Lights And Lines AlbumWritingClub. The collection delves deeper into themes explored on *Fractured*, a record that addressed relationships and communication through the lens of emotional resilience.

Now, with "Almost," Beth Sarah is exploring new sonic territories while maintaining her signature emotional honesty. This album features tracks like "The Same Moon (Red Lights)" and showcases a more groove-led, soulful sound, an evolution that complements the album's themes without losing its core essence.

Beth Sarah's musical journey can be traced through each release: from her debut single in 2020 to the critically acclaimed *Fractured* in 2025 and now "Almost." Each step forward demonstrates a continued commitment to exploring complex emotions with unflinching honesty. Her ability to translate personal experiences into universal relatable narratives makes Beth Sarah stand out as an artist who truly embodies vulnerability, emotion, and authenticity.

In the spirit of Beautifully Unfinished, fans can look forward to experiencing Beth Sarah's creative process firsthand through her upcoming album *Almost*, where uncertainty becomes a source of strength and beauty. Whether listening in or following along on social media, there is no doubt that this artist will continue to move listeners with her unique voice for years to come.



Inside Out: A Star for All to See

Sean MacLeod and his new release stand out with his unique blend of melodic indie pop, alternative rock, folk, psychedelia and experimental influences. This innovative Irish artist has been exploring the depths of human experience and existential questions through thoughtful, philosophical songwriting for over three decades.

MacLeod's latest solo album, *That's When the Earth Becomes a Star*, released in 2026, is another testament to his singular vision. Drawing on strong influences ranging from The Beatles, David Bowie and The Beach Boys to The Stone Roses and Blur, MacLeod has created an album that moves between intimate reflection and expansive ideas.

The title *That's When the Earth Becomes a Star* encapsulates the underlying fascination of seeing the familiar differently, a shift in perspective where the world can suddenly appear altered, illuminated, or newly understood. This concept is brilliantly illustrated through songs that consider love, alienation, hope, identity, and transformation, all balanced with memorable melodies and lyrics inviting closer attention.

That's When the Earth Becomes a Star showcases MacLeod's richly melodic indie-pop framework, paired with his unconventional edge in musical composition and alternative tuning systems. The album moves fluidly between introspective moments and broader explorations of human experience, all underpinned by strong songwriting that resonates deeply.

One of the album's standout tracks is "Inside Out (Radio Edit)", which delves into the pressures of contemporary life with a brooding guitar sound, melodic hooks, and an indie-rock groove. This single brings these ideas into sharp focus, inviting listeners to meditate on modern identity within a world increasingly disconnected by technology and consumerism.

MacLeod's artistic versatility extends beyond his music. He is also an author and filmmaker, having penned books on the girl groups of the 1960s, Phil Spector, and The Beatles, as well as holding a PhD in Music Composition (Practice-as-Research) from the University of Limerick. His research has led to original docudrama projects like *When the Earth Becomes a Star*.

In addition to his music, MacLeod has released *We Don't See That We Don't See*, an experimental companion record that further explores similar ideas through tuning, timbre, instrumentation and the nature of listening itself. This album challenges listeners to reconsider how we hear, pushing them to consider what they feel, perceive, and might happen when they begin to see differently.

That's When the Earth Becomes a Star is not just an album; it's a journey through a spectrum world that MacLeod has meticulously crafted. Each track invites deeper engagement with the themes of love, alienation, hope, identity, and transformation. The result is a cohesive body of work that both entertains and provokes thought.

Sean MacLeod remains a standout figure in contemporary music, both for his singular voice and vision as an artist and for his continued exploration of human experience through music, literature, and film. With *That's When the Earth Becomes a Star*, he has once again pushed the boundaries of what is possible within the realm of musical composition and songwriting.



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FIRST LISTEN

Fish And Scale: The Mystic Folkman



Roland Wälzlein, known by his artistic moniker Fish And Scale, has built an empire of songs that resonate deep within the soul. His latest album, "Elf," is a testament to the multifaceted nature of his creative identity, a blend of old and new tracks from his extensive musical journey.

Each track on "Elf" carries with it the weighty questions of life, love, loss, mortality, and what lies beyond. The album's title itself hints at its mystical essence, evoking a sense of wonder and mystery that permeates throughout every song. Fish And Scale navigates these themes masterfully, weaving them into an atmospheric tapestry of soulful folk music.

The artist's distinctive voice serves as the beating heart of this collection, a voice both powerful and passionate but also subtle and profound. Wälzlein has developed his sound to be uniquely identifiable, a blend of traditional folk elements with a modern, mystical twist that sets him apart from conventional artists in the genre. His voice often carries a smoky quality reminiscent of Mick Jagger, lending an almost haunting quality to his performances.

THE STORY

Fish And Scale's music is not merely about catchy tunes or straightforward melodies; it delves deep into the complexities and contradictions of human experience. The result is a body of work that feels both timeless and deeply personal, making each listen feel like a new discovery.

The album's production quality is equally noteworthy. From the lush harmonies to the intricate instrumental arrangements, every element contributes to the cohesive atmosphere created by Fish And Scale. These details underscore the depth of his creative vision, each piece perfectly crafted to enhance the overall narrative woven through his lyrics.

For Roland Wälzlein, the path that led him to this point has been marked by significant life experiences and pivotal moments. As a six-year-old child, he survived a serious heart operation, a harrowing ordeal that left an indelible mark on his psyche. This early encounter with mortality inspired countless existential questions, which found their way into his lyrics.

A turning point in Wälzlein's artistic development came during his first stay at what he describes as a "silent retreat." This experience not only transformed how he viewed life but also profoundly influenced the direction of his music. The mysticism and depth that characterize Fish And Scale's work can be traced back to these formative experiences.

At the core of his artistry is an unwavering commitment to producing authentic, heartfelt music. Through his songs, Wälzlein invites listeners to engage with their own hearts and minds, prompting introspection on fundamental aspects of existence. Each album feels like a conversation between artist and audience, soliciting responses from the listener as they navigate the rich landscape of emotional depth and existential inquiry.

Fish And Scale's latest effort, "Elf," represents not just another chapter in his musical journey but an invitation to dive deeper into the mysteries that define us all. Whether you find solace or challenge within these tracks, one thing is certain: Roland Wälzlein has crafted a body of work that challenges conventions and invites listeners to explore their own muses.



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RETROSPECTIVE



"Will": A Standout Composition

"WILL": A STANDOUT COMPOSITION

Roi Aknin's new single "Will" stands as a beacon of resilience and emotional depth. This powerful pop-rock ballad is more than just another track; it's a testament to the human spirit's enduring capacity for creation.

Born from raw emotion and penned in the midst of turmoil, "Will" poignantly encapsulates the universal struggle against fear. The song not only resonates with listeners but also stands as a poignant reminder of hope amidst darkness. Roi Aknin, an Israeli songwriter and artist who blends pop-rock into his repertoire with grace, has crafted a release that is both intimate and universal.

The song's foundation lies in its honest exploration of personal pain and fear during times of crisis. Its emotional authenticity speaks to the plight of those grappling with the unknown, offering solace through its unwavering message of resilience. Written solely by Roi Aknin, who channels his experiences into every note, "Will" is a deeply personal yet universally relatable piece.

The production quality elevates this song to new heights. Nela Ruiz, an Argentinian producer, ensures that the track's emotional impact is amplified without losing its grounding in straightforward storytelling. The anonymous American female session singer lends her vocals with precision and emotion, making

"Will" a standout composition from start to finish.

From its lyrical depths to its sonic layers, "Will" showcases Roi Aknin's versatility as both a songwriter and artist. His ability to weave together themes of social cause, personal expression, and raw human emotion creates a musical tapestry that is both comforting and invigorating.

As he continues to create music with such sensitivity and integrity, Roi Aknin stands out in the crowded landscape of independent artists. "Will" serves as a vivid example of what can be achieved when an artist combines personal experience with artistic vision, a fusion that resonates deeply with listeners everywhere.



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Q & A

Drums for Clowns Turn the Weight of the Past Into Something Beautiful



Some songs age with the people who wrote them. Others seem to wait patiently for the world to catch up with them. For Drums for Clowns, "Grave Concern" belongs firmly in the latter category. First released in 2003, the song has returned more than two decades later with its emotional core intact, offering a renewed introduction to a band whose music has always been rooted in experience rather than fashion.

Emerging in the late 1990s, Drums for Clowns established themselves through a combination of forceful live performances and songwriting that refused to hide from difficult subjects. Their music sits somewhere between alternative rock, post punk and melodic indie, but those labels only tell part of the story. The defining quality is emotional directness. These are songs shaped by grief, love, addiction, hope and survival, written with the kind of conviction that comes from having lived through the subjects rather than simply observing them.

At the centre of that approach is songwriter and frontman Kit Cooper. His writing has long been concerned with the complicated territory between despair and resilience, where painful memories can coexist with the possibility of moving forward. Rather than softening those experiences into easily digestible narratives, Cooper allows them to retain their weight. That honesty gives the band's work an unusual sense of intimacy, even when the arrangements expand into something much larger.

"Grave Concern" is a particularly strong example. Its return is not simply an exercise in nostalgia, nor does it feel like an attempt to recreate an earlier moment for its own sake. The song carries the atmosphere of its original era while speaking

with remarkable relevance to the present. Its themes of loss, grief and mental health have not become less significant with time. If anything, the years have given the song additional emotional resonance.

Musically, the track draws listeners into an atmospheric space where melody and tension work together. Drums for Clowns have always understood the value of contrast, allowing haunting passages to sit alongside larger guitar moments and memorable choruses. The result is music that can feel intimate one moment and expansive the next. There is a cinematic quality to the band's sound, but it never overwhelms the songwriting. The production serves the emotional narrative, giving the guitars room to soar while keeping the vocal at the centre of the experience.

That balance is important to the band's wider identity. Their music can carry the energy required for a festival stage, yet it also works in more intimate settings where every lyric has the opportunity to land. Their history of performing for audiences across Europe, North America and Canada reflects that versatility. They have developed a following not simply because of the scale of their performances, but because listeners recognise something personal in the material.

There is also a refreshing lack of concern with chasing whatever sound happens to dominate at a particular moment. Drums for Clowns have remained fiercely independent, and that independence is audible. Their songs do not feel engineered around a trend. Instead, the band have developed a musical language built from strong melodies, atmospheric guitars, emotional vocals and choruses that are designed to linger.

That approach helps explain why a song first released in 2003 can return with such conviction. "Grave Concern" does not depend on its history to make an impression. Heard on its own, it is a deeply affecting piece of alternative rock. Knowing its history simply adds another layer. More than twenty years have passed since its original release, yet the emotions at its centre remain recognisable to anyone who has experienced absence, struggled with mental health, or carried the memory of someone whose influence continues long after their departure.

For Cooper, songwriting appears to function as both reflection and release. The personal nature of his lyrics gives Drums for Clowns a distinctive emotional credibility, but the band's strength lies in their ability to transform those private experiences into something shared. The songs may begin with individual pain, but they leave room for listeners to bring their own stories into them.

That is perhaps the most enduring quality of Drums for Clowns. Their music does not pretend that darkness can simply be overcome by positive thinking. Instead, it acknowledges the damage, sits with it, and searches for whatever remains on the other side. Hope is present, but it is earned rather than assumed.

With "Grave Concern" returning to the spotlight, a new generation has the opportunity to discover a song that has already travelled a considerable distance. Its renewed life also places the broader Drums for Clowns catalogue in a new context, reminding listeners that powerful songwriting is not necessarily tied to a particular year, scene or moment in popular culture.



After the Crossing: A Beacon of Compassion in Rock Music



Harry Kappen, has carved his own niche as a voice for those who quietly but selflessly take action to help others. Harry's latest album, "After the Crossing," released after he moved from the Netherlands to Mexico, showcases his unique blend of introspective songwriting and powerful performance that resonates with listeners on an emotional level. The ten songs collected here span a spectrum range from subdued ballads to anthemic rockers, all performed by Kappen himself, a testament to his versatile musicality.

One of the album's most stirring tracks is "Good Samaritans," a firm and energetic rock song that pays homage to those who selflessly step in during times of crisis. With its catchy chorus featuring contributions from Mexican singer Danna Gomez, it's not just music; it's an ode to individuals whose actions are often overshadowed by the noise of daily life.

The track "Good Samaritans" nods back to David Bowie, a fellow artist who passed away ten years ago. Bowie was known for his emotional depth and ability to blend rock with artistry, much like Kappen does here. The single's release follows the success of

"Distant Shore," another poignant ballad that explores themes close to Kappen's heart.

Like many musicians, Harry Kappen has found solace in music therapy during his career as a therapist for youth care, where he worked with individuals and families. His ability to connect deeply with his patients is reflected in the intimate production quality of "After the Crossing," which allows each song to resonate without distraction or intrusion. The result is an album that feels both personal and universal, touching on themes like loneliness, hope, and the importance of kindness.

Kappen's journey from being a local performer in Groningen, the northern Netherlands, to becoming a multi-instrumentalist with international recognition speaks volumes about his dedication to music therapy and his musical identity. His extensive experience working with clients has undoubtedly informed his songwriting, ensuring that each lyric carries weight and sincerity.

The album's recent success is a testament to Kappen's growing reputation in the industry. He received significant accolades this year for his work on "After the Crossing," including

the Elite Music Award as Songwriter of the Year and the IMN Award for Favorite Impact Artist. His earlier works, such as "Four" which won ISSA (Instituto Superior de Sonido y Artes Musicales) Award for Album of the Year, also demonstrate his consistency and depth.

Kappen's influence extends beyond these formal recognitions; his music has resonated deeply with fans on platforms like Spotify. His latest release promises to further solidify his position as a standout voice in contemporary rock music, particularly known for its emotional resonance and artistic integrity.

In an era where fame often overshadows genuine contributions, Harry Kappen stands as a reminder of the power that lies within quiet, selfless acts of kindness. His journey from Groningen to Mexico showcases not only geographical displacement but also a profound transformation in his artistry, resulting in music that is both personal and universally impactful.

For fans eager to experience this musical voyage for themselves, Harry Kappen's latest album "After the Crossing" is now available on all major streaming platforms, offering a fresh chapter of rock music with deep emotional layers.

Valley Taylor's One Hundred Billion Points of Light



VALLEY TAYLOR'S ONE HUNDRED BILLION POINTS OF LIGHT

Valley Taylor released an album that feels like a personal journey through time, blending intimate songwriting with experimental production to create something both haunting and compelling. One Hundred Billion Points of Light by Valley Taylor is more than just another eight-song release; it's a testament to the power of persistence and creativity. The project began as a collection of rough demos, conceived as a straightforward garage-band record. However, over time, these initial ideas evolved into something far more complex and intricate.

The album sees the artist, known for his meticulous approach to production, preserving the emotional character of those original demos while pushing the technical boundaries. Through contributions from friends such as Geoff Nelson, Devin Zamora, David Hollenbeck, and mastering by Alec Beretz, Taylor crafts a work that is both deeply personal and remarkably polished.

Each track on this album reveals a different layer of complexity, moving fluidly between intimate guitar-driven moments and more experimental arrangements. "Dog" and "Don't You Wanna Be Fine?" are standout tracks, weaving together elements of lo-fi textures with rich

digital manipulation to create an immersive listening experience that feels both familiar and distinctly new.

THE STORY

Valley Taylor's musical identity is deeply rooted in the influences that first shaped him. From the dreamy atmospheres of Radiohead's *In Rainbows* to the introspective melodies of Bon Iver, Valley has drawn inspiration from these seminal acts and more. Songs like "Dog" and "Don't You Wanna Be Fine?" showcase his ability to move fluidly between quieter bedroom recordings and dense, maximalist arrangements.

The album's structure often reflects Taylor's creative vision: a cohesive journey through various emotional landscapes rather than standalone singles. Each song feels like part of a larger narrative, one that explores nostalgia, imperfection, and the sometimes strange yet ultimately comforting nature of music making.

Beyond the recorded music, Valley Taylor's work extends to visual art forms, drawing, photography, animation, video, and web design. This expansive creative practice is not just supplementary material but a seamless extension

of his musical output. Each release comes with a carefully curated visual environment that complements the music.

Taylor builds these small worlds around each album, creating immersive experiences for listeners. The interconnectedness of his various artistic disciplines creates an ecosystem where different forms of expression inform and enhance one another. This multidisciplinary approach underscores the holistic nature of Valley Taylor's project.

One Hundred Billion Points of Light arrives on September 19, 2026, marking a significant step forward in Valley Taylor's career. With its blend of technical prowess and emotional depth, this album promises to cement his place among contemporary indie music makers. The artist's commitment to both preservation and innovation sets him apart from many of his contemporaries.

As listeners dive into these eight songs, they are invited on a journey through time, memory, and self-discovery, each track offering a unique glimpse into Valley Taylor's creative spirit. Whether one is drawn in by the stark realism or captivated by the surreal beauty of this work, One Hundred Billion Points of Light serves as an essential addition to contemporary indie music.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

FEATURE

Independent artist Exzenya has now unveiled a new single that ventures into uncharted territory: roots rock. This latest offering is an electrifying blend of blues-rock with teeth, blending mid-tempo storytelling and live-band feel with the sultry urgency of her earlier work.

Exzenya's signature voice cuts through the mix like razor blades, sassy yet soulful, raw and resilient in equal measure. With a new single titled "Bitch Please," she once again takes on a complex social issue with a blend of sass, vulnerability, and humor that set the bar high for her previous work.

At its core, "Bitch Please" is an unapologetic narrative about facing the harsh realities of cheating. The single opens with a woman looking at someone who slept with their husband, the very man they thought had their back, forcing her to confront the bitter truth. It's a song that speaks directly from the heart, crafted out of personal experience and raw emotion.

The title itself, "Bitch Please", is a declaration of empowerment over any attempts at dismissing or trivializing her story. Exzenya uses this single as an opportunity to shine light on situations where women find themselves in toxic relationships, providing a voice that is often silenced or ignored. The song's chorus "You thought you were taking my life. You set me free" encapsulates both the relief of breaking free and the clarity gained from the ordeal.

What sets Exzenya apart from other artists is her ability to pen songs with a voice all her own. Her lyrics are personal, intimate, and often starkly honest, a trait that has endeared her to fans who appreciate genuine storytelling. "Bitch Please" continues this tradition, offering listeners a raw portrayal of navigating through the aftermath of infidelity.

Exzenya's creative vision is clear: she aims to bridge pop sensibilities with roots music for something bold and distinctive. Her choice of genre, a blend of blues-rock infused with R&B, underscores her unique artistic identity. The production quality is impeccable, featuring expert engineering that elevates each vocal performance to new heights.

While "Bitch Please" leans heavily into roots rock, the artist draws from influences across various genres. Exzenya channels the energy of artists like Dorothy (who brings a bluesy grit) and Kaleo (whose intimate acoustic songs offer inspiration). Her work with Barns Courtney and Grandson hints at the

collaborative nature that she embraces to evolve her sound.

Exzenya's most recent collaboration is not just an extension of her artistic ambitions but also a testament to her growing reach. Her songs have already found their way into popular radio playlists, showcasing how her music resonates beyond her own network. This single marks her departure from the pop-R&B she initially debuted with and cements her position as an artist who can navigate genres seamlessly.

"Bitch Please": Exzenya's Blazing Roots Rock Revelations



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

SPOTLIGHT

Surrealist R&B: Odelet's Triumphant Triple Album

There is only a small number of artists who have ever attempted to release three albums as part of a single creative journey, and Odelet's latest body of work stands out as something truly exceptional. Her latest album, *Soul Obscura*, is part of a triptych that began with *Raindance* and its remix album, *Raindance in Dub* with Larry Crane and Jackpot!, and continues through her distinctive explorations of genre, sound, and visual art. The journey has been anything but conventional. Odelet has created a series of groundbreaking works, each occupying its own musical space while remaining seamlessly cohesive, a testament to her singular creativity.

Born in Detroit, MI, Odelet now resides on the West Coast. Known for a unique writing style that draws inspiration from a wide range of musical influences, she dissolves the boundaries between genres with ease. More than just a gifted singer and songwriter, Odelet is also a producer, writing and performing nearly all of her instrumentation. Her experimental music visuals have been selected for screening at more than fifty film festivals internationally and have won numerous awards. Her work defies boundaries; she is a creator without limits.

Odelet's latest album, *Soul Obscura*, marks a significant chapter in an ambitious series of releases. Her work explores different genres and approaches while maintaining a distinct artistic identity throughout. *Soul Obscura* stands as a compelling continuation of her evolving creative vision, bringing together the many threads of her songwriting, production, and performance.

The album begins with a performance mix by legendary engineer Larry Crane, created using analog drums produced with his signature precision at Jackpot! Recording Studio in Portland, OR. Odelet then layers her own instrumentation over this foundation,

drums, bass, and melodies crafted from synthesizers and keyboards — and performs the material live. This approach epitomizes her commitment to creating immersive experiences that blur the lines between live performance and studio recording.

Odelet's latest album is a standout example of Surrealist R&B, a sound she has pioneered by seamlessly blending elements of hip-hop, singer-songwriter music, and electronic production. Each track on *Soul Obscura* stands alone as an artful creation, yet together the songs form a cohesive narrative that invites listeners into Odelet's imaginative world.

Fans who are partial to her earlier work will find *Raindance* and its remix album, *Raindance in Dub* with Larry Crane and Jackpot!, where she experiments further within the Surrealist R&B framework. For those seeking a more intimate look at her songwriting and recording process, fans can anticipate live video performance episodes from these sessions.

Odelet's versatility is evident not only in her production but also in her live performances. Her music speaks to audiences with deep emotional resonance, inviting them into vivid imaginations and complex stories. Whether she is crafting an intricate hip-hop beat, building atmospheric textures with synthesizers and keyboards, or delivering an emotionally charged vocal performance, Odelet uses every element of her musical palette as a means of storytelling.

Odelet's work is defining, casting a new light on what can be achieved in music when an artist is unapologetically true to her own creative impulses. With *Soul Obscura*, her newest release, Odelet stands at the forefront of contemporary music creation, offering listeners a singular experience that continues to unfold and evolve with each passing track.



SURREALIST R&B: ODELET'S TRIUMPHANT TRIPLE ALBUM

DEEP DIVE

Stoners Trail: A Journey Through Pain and Promise

On September 4th, 2026, Los Angeles-based multi-instrumentalist Erik David Hidde released his ambitious sophomore album, "Stoners Trail." This release marks a new chapter for Mohawk Castle, the project that stands as a testament to Hidde's creative evolution and his unique blend of influences.

Mohawk Castle is more than just another artist in the independent music scene. Hidde, formerly known by the moniker Prison Escapee, has carved out a distinct identity through his prolific output across multiple projects. From his work with Not a Thing to Believe In and Capital Unknowns to founding the groundbreaking digital-only label

Housewarming Records, Hidde's journey is one of relentless dedication and creative control.

Each album from Mohawk Castle is an expression of Hidde's personal experiences. This latest release is no different. "Stoners Trail" takes its name from a near-death car accident Hidde survived in upstate New York, a moment that has profoundly shaped his perspective and creative output.

The album delves into a wide array of themes, ranging from the weighty issues of PTSD-suffering veterans and end times prophecy to deeply personal explorations. Songs like "Draw a

Draw Bridge to Me," inspired by Hidde's experiences during his debut album sessions, serve as meditations on the interconnectedness of life, while "You Look Just Like the Stars" finds its place as a poignant, last-minute addition that brings closure to the collection.

Hidde's production prowess is evident throughout "Stoners Trail." The eclectic blend of influences, touchstones from Animal Collective and LCD Soundsystem, to The National and Broken Social Scene, creates an album that defies categorization. Hidde's mastery over all aspects of his work, from writing and recording to producing, arranging, mixing, and mastering, is evident in every track.

"Each album from Mohawk Castle is an expression of Hidde's personal experiences."

The depth of emotional resonance in "Stoners Trail" is both striking and compelling. Each song carries a layer of vulnerability and reflection, showcasing Hidde's journey from the personal to the universal. From introspective moments like "Draw a Draw Bridge to Me," which captures the intimacy of sharing experiences with loved ones, to anthemic tracks that evoke a sense of unity and hope.

The album's artwork by Samuel Condon and Erik David Hidde himself complements this emotional depth. The choice of "Tree Study (Jade)" as the cover art underscores the artist's commitment to exploring nature as both a physical presence and a metaphor for personal growth.

Mohawk Castle has long been known for its innovative approach within the independent music community, and

"Stoners Trail" is no exception. With complete creative control over every aspect of his work, Hidde maintains the same hands-on approach that has defined his extensive catalog. His deep knowledge of music history positions him not only as an accomplished artist but also as a respected voice.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL



SCENE REPORT

THE BACKBONE OF A NEW BREED



Backbone is a track full of raw honesty and undeniable grit. This song, produced from the dusty depths of Turner's Dutch Delta, speaks to a universal emotion that transcends genre: the need for perseverance in an ever-changing world.

Joseph Turner & The Dudes of Hazard have carved out a unique niche in the indie/alternative scene with their blend of acoustic roots-rock and Americana. "Backbone" is a testament to their ability to craft songs that feel both timeless and deeply personal, offering listeners a glimpse into the raw spirit of their creative process.

THE STORY

At its core, "Backbone" is an anthem for those who have weathered many storms but continue to carry on with unyielding determination. Turner's keen ear for storytelling is evident in his lyrics, which paint vivid pictures of a journey marked by both hardship and triumph. The chorus captures that struggle with the lines, "Blood on my fingers, dirt on my toes / Must keep on fightin', gotta take control." The words convey the song's determination without losing sight of the grit at its heart.

The track is driven by acoustic guitar work that cuts through with raw energy, complemented by foot stomps, handclaps, and Turner's signature vocals. A

distinctive feature of "Backbone" is its rhythmic shoveling motif, which gives the song a work-song pulse. This element serves as both a nod to classic American folk music and an invitation for listeners to join in on the storytelling.

Musically, Joseph Turner & The Dudes of Hazard are masters at weaving together disparate influences into cohesive compositions that feel authentic and lived-in. Their production quality is impeccable, yet they maintain a palpable energy that comes from recording everything themselves. This hands-on approach allows them to capture every nuance of their creative process, from the raw emotion in Turner's vocals to the dynamic interplay between instruments.

The Dudes of Hazard are known for their live performances, where they bring an unpredictable yet honest energy to their shows. These impromptu collaborations among friends and collaborators add a layer of unpredictability that keeps audiences engaged and involved. The ability to quickly adapt and incorporate different voices into their sound is both a testament to their collaborative spirit and a hallmark of their unique identity.

"Backbone" marks Turner & The Dudes of Hazard's debut single, but it's clear they are capable of much more. With each new release, they continue to push the boundaries of what makes them distinctive, melding acoustic prowess with robust storytelling that resonates deeply with listeners who value authenticity and emotional depth in their music.

JOSEPH
TURNER
& THE DUDES
OF HAZARD



PROFILE

The Orchestral Whisperer



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

In a world where digital production often dominates the landscape of pop music, Jacob Barrett stands out as an artist whose work breathes life into old-world instruments and modern sensibilities. His latest single, "Here I Go Again," is a testament to his ability to weave orchestral arrangements with contemporary pop production, creating songs that are both emotionally resonant and technically.

Barrett's journey towards crafting such masterful compositions began from humble beginnings. The track's foundation was laid during an unconventional setting, his college dorm room where he collaborated remotely with musicians across the globe. This approach not only pushed Barrett to his creative limits but also allowed him to incorporate a wide array of instruments into his music, resulting in a sound that is both expansive and intimate.

From cello glides to synth-driven beats, "Here I Go Again" is an auditory feast for the senses. The song's structure is nothing short of ingenious, with each verse shifting keys for

added depth and emotional impact. This unique approach not only keeps listeners engaged but also rewards repeated listens.

Barrett's influences are as diverse as his sound. From the confessional lyricism of Olivia Rodrigo to the intimate storytelling of Tracy Chapman, he blends these elements seamlessly into a genre that is both familiar yet forward-thinking. The result is a body of work that feels deeply personal while maintaining an air of universality, songs that resonate with anyone who has ever felt the weight of chronic illness and its aftermath.

Writing, performing, and producing "Here I Go Again" was no small feat. Barrett utilized remote recording platforms like Musiversal to bring in session musicians from Malaysia and across the United States, ensuring the highest quality sound. His close friend Wilder Kagay provided bass duties, while Karl Force at Outpost Studio SF contributed additional mixing assistance for a touch of polish.

The song's lead vocals are particularly noteworthy; they capture both precision and emotion, drawing parallels to artists like Billie Eilish and Noga Erez. These elements come together in perfect harmony, creating a sound that is as punchy as it is nuanced, reflecting Barrett's commitment to meticulous production amidst his eclectic musical palette.

Following the release of "Here I Go Again," Barrett will be releasing an upcoming EP that promises more of the same, a collection of songs that showcase his artistic vision and songwriting prowess. This new material builds upon the foundation laid with "Through the Looking Glass," each track contributing to a narrative about living through challenging times.

As he continues to navigate the complexities of chronic illness, Barrett's music serves as both catharsis and inspiration. His unique ability to blend personal narratives with sophisticated production techniques makes him a standout figure in contemporary pop music.



THE ORCHESTRAL WHISPERER

FIRST LISTEN

Shining Brighter Than Sunlight



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

Tia-Brittany with her latest album, *DTF*, captivates audiences not just with her musical prowess but also through her raw storytelling and fearless songwriting.

Born into a multicultural family whose roots stretch across Australia, England, Ireland, and Barbados, Tia-Brittany's diverse artistic upbringing has endowed her with an emotional depth that is both expansive and intimate. While pursuing a career in music, she simultaneously studies psychology at the Australian Institute of Music and continues to hone her skills as an actress. Her dedication to classical opera under the tutelage of Maria Timofeeva further enriches her vocal palette, giving her songs a rich texture and profound lyrical content.

Don't Talk Feelings, the album's standout single, is more than just a catchy tune; it is a testament to Tia-Brittany's growing confidence in her creative voice. Released as part of *DTF*, this track encapsulates the emotional vulnerability at the heart of the collection. It serves as both an entry point into Tia-Brittany's world and a beacon that signals her intent to push boundaries and connect with listeners on a deeply personal level.

The production quality is equally noteworthy, courtesy of John Ho and Daniela Rivera, who have crafted an album that is not merely polished but purposeful. The collaborative spirit extends beyond the music itself; Tia-Brittany's latest venture into television writing and her

upcoming TV series with internationally recognized filmmaker Pauline Chan underscore her commitment to storytelling across various mediums.

The visual identity of *DTF* reflects this holistic artistic vision, as demonstrated by its captivating music video directed by Pauline Chan. This creative partnership is part of a larger ecosystem that includes Geoff Newton's forthcoming collaboration on the television series. Such cross-pollination across different forms of art speaks volumes about Tia-Brittany's expansive artistic palette and her willingness to explore new frontiers.

Tia-Brittany's journey as an artist has been marked by both personal hardships and triumphs. Her experience caring for her mother through breast cancer treatment has not only forged a deeper understanding of resilience but also infused her songwriting with authenticity and honesty. This lived experience, combined with her passion for cinema, underpins the emotional depth and narrative strength that define Tia-Brittany's work.

With *DTF* and its standout single *Don't Talk Feelings*, Tia-Brittany is sending a clear message: her musical journey continues to be one of boldness and authenticity. As she reaches new listeners around the world, Tia-Brittany stands as an artist poised for great things, ready to define her place in the ever-evolving landscape of music.



Unveiling the Dark Anthems of Blade Of Thorns

BLADE OF THORNS is a London-based industrial rockers whose raw, uncompromising sound carries a weighty message as potent and personal as any anthem.

BLADE OF THORNS was born from the depths of emotional turmoil, a mission to channel their darkest experiences into melodies that not only resonate with listeners but also offer solace. Their debut album is a testament to this ethos, blending dark industrial tones with progressive and metal energy in every song. From atmospheric ballads that whisper secrets from behind closed doors, to aggressive assaults on the eardrum, and even rap-infused experiments that challenge conventional boundaries, BLADE OF THORNS leaves no room for mediocrity.

The foundation of their sound is forged by the intense personal experiences that have shaped them as artists. Drawing inspiration from post-grunge grit and industrial rock intensity, each track becomes a testament to resilience in the face of adversity. What started as raw emotions now blooms into anthems designed to uplift anyone who has ever felt lost or alone.

BLADE OF THORNS is more than just music; they are champions for mental health awareness and advocates against animal cruelty. Their SaveTheBeagles campaign resonates deeply with their audience, making them more than a band, they're a community that uses art as a tool to make the world a better place.

In a landscape dominated by corporate-driven sounds, BLADE OF THORNS stands out as a beacon of authenticity. Their music isn't just for entertainment; it's an antidote to modern isolationism. With every note, they remind us all that we are not alone in our struggles and that hope is always within reach.

For those ready to embrace the raw power of BLADE OF THORNS' sound, their latest release promises a journey through the darkest corners of the soul, accompanied by anthems of unwavering resilience. Whether it's their most intimate moments or their boldest confrontations with reality, every track serves as a mirror reflecting the universal human experience.

Whether you're a fan of industrial rock or simply someone seeking solace in music's rawest form, BLADE OF THORNS has something profound and unifying to offer. Their mission is clear: if their music helps even one person realize they are not alone, then they have achieved exactly what they set out to do.

In a world where many artists cater to commercial expectations, BLADE OF THORNS stands as an outlier, raw, unrelenting, and free from any compromise. This London-based industrial rock band channels their deepest emotions into music that resonates deeply with listeners, turning personal struggles into anthems of resilience for those fighting their own battles.

Their debut album is a whirlwind tour through various genres, from atmospheric ballads to heavy metal assaults, and even rap-infused experiments. Each song reveals a different side of Blade of Thorns, raw and unyielding, yet imbued with an emotional depth that cuts straight to the core.

BLADE OF THORNS crafts their sound with influences spanning post-grunge grit and industrial rock intensity. Their mission is simple: if their music helps even one person realize they are not alone, then it has achieved its purpose. They proudly stand for mental health awareness and support animal rights initiatives like SaveTheBeagles.

In a crowded industry dominated by corporate soundtracks, BLADE OF THORNS offers something uniquely distinct, a message of hope, resilience, and community. Their music isn't just an escape; it's a mirror reflecting the universal human experience. Whether you're moved by their intimate moments or inspired by their confrontations with reality, every track serves as a beacon illuminating our shared humanity.

For our readers that are ready to dive into BLADE OF THORNS' world of raw, unrelenting music, their latest release promises a journey through the darkest corners of the soul, accompanied by anthems that stand tall against adversity. Discover the unique power and depth of Blade Of Thorns today.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

Mark Peters & The Craft of Authenticity



With "Ton Of Bricks," Mark Peters & The Dark Band channels his roots through a blend of folk, country, blues, and jazz, crafting an intimate ode to understanding and recognition.

Mark Peters is more than just a name; he's a living testimony to the enduring power of songwriting. Known for his distinctive fingerstyle guitar playing, Mark's music radiates authenticity born from personal experiences and the everyday madness that defines our lives. His latest single, "Ton Of Bricks," marks a bold step into new sonic territory, capturing an authenticity reminiscent of times long lost in modern music production.

THE STORY

The song's genesis can be traced back to Mark's home studio, where he used modest equipment to create something entirely his own. Inspired by the moody blues/folk ballads that inspired him as a young artist with sixties and seventies music, "Ton Of Bricks" features intricate classical guitar intertwined with atmospheric electric textures over an hypnotic drum groove. The result is a hauntingly beautiful melody that speaks volumes about human connection.

At its core, Mark's lyrics are a message of understanding, a universal yearning for recognition and acceptance in a world often filled with

judgment. "Ton Of Bricks" encapsulates these themes through poignant storytelling, weaving together elements of blues, folk, country, and jazz to create a rich tapestry that resonates deeply with listeners.

"The result is a hauntingly beautiful melody that speaks volumes about human connection."

But it's not just the lyrics that make "Ton Of Bricks" stand out; its production quality is nothing short of exceptional. The track's delicate balance between classical guitar and electric textures creates an immersive sonic landscape, drawing the listener into a world where sound serves as both storyteller and companion.

In the age of AI, where production might overshadow creative output, Mark Peters & The Dark Band stands as a shining example of true musical mastery. With "Ton Of Bricks," they've created not just another song, but a sonic document that captures the essence of what it means to make music with heart and soul.

C'BATCH AND THE CINEMATIC INVITATION

The new single from C'batch's EP "Our Little Pooh Pea (The Last Light)" is not just another entry in the ever-expanding library of indie music; it's a testament to the power and creativity that lies within an artist's ability to reinvent existing material.

C'batch, or Stephen H. Cumberbatch as he is known professionally, has built a reputation for his distinct musical style, merging elements of electronic, dream pop, ambient, and experimental production into one uniquely vivid narrative. His latest offering, "Our Little Pooh Pea (The Last Light) 4 - Cinematic," represents a fascinating exploration of the creative process itself.

This single originated from a simple guitar solo that C'batch originally composed for his track "Round & Round." Over time, as he revisited this composition, he discovered something remarkable within the raw performance, the melody and rhythm contained therein were capable of evoking an entirely different story. Instead of burying this potential in the shadows of its original form, C'batch decided to give it new life through a radical transformation.

The result is a mesmerizing instrumental that pulses with an emotional depth akin to a dreamlike narrative. It weaves between electronic and atmospheric territory, creating a sonic landscape that captivates the listener's imagination. "Our Little Pooh Pea (The Last Light) 4 - Cinematic" captures the essence of hope in darkness, much like the title suggests.

C'batch's work with Stevette Music, Inc., his own independent music publishing company, showcases an artist who is not content to rest on laurels but continues to push boundaries and explore new creative avenues. With a catalog that includes collaborations such as "I Need You Now" by Sinnamon and "Playgirls" by Kreamsicle, C'batch has established himself as a versatile and innovative figure in the music industry.

What sets him apart is his ability to take an existing performance or composition and transform it into something entirely new. In essence, he's not just composing; he's crafting experiences that resonate on multiple levels, weaving together different genres and emotions to create a cohesive whole. It's this kind of storytelling through sound that makes C'batch one of the most intriguing artists in today's indie music scene.

His latest release is more than just another single; it's an invitation for listeners to join him as he navigates the complex interplay between darkness and light, joy and despair. "Our Little Pooh Pea (The Last Light) 4 - Cinematic" offers a vivid illustration of how even the most modest musical gesture can be reborn into something truly extraordinary.



Our Little Pooh Pea (The Last Light)



LONG READ

Mariana Trench: A Symphony of Resilience

Paul Garside with his most recent release, "Mariana Trench," crafts something truly special, a contemporary folk-rock anthem that resonates with the soulful stories of those who have fought against personal darkness.

"Mariana Trench" is not just another song; it's a testament to Garside's unwavering commitment to creating music that speaks directly from his heart. The title itself, a nod to the deepest ocean trench, serves as both metaphor and mission statement for the artist's journey, feeling isolated, pressured, and far from the light of hope.

The song's chord progressions ascend and descend, mirroring the intricate path through mental health struggles. This musical journey is more than just lyrics; it's a symphony of resilience played out in notes and tones. Garside masterfully weaves together his acoustic storytelling with a distinctive blend of international percussion elements, creating an irresistible sense of movement toward the surface.

Recorded at RMS Studios in Selhurst Park, London, "Mariana Trench" is more than just a project; it's a collaborative masterpiece.

Garside has assembled an impressive cast of musicians hailing from diverse corners of the globe, Scotland, Uganda, Poland, and Finland, to craft this rich tapestry. Each instrument takes center stage in what can only be described as a "big room" production, highlighting the unique contributions of each player.

Jamie Jordan's Scottish bodhran meets JJ Bugoma's Ugandan percussion in perfect harmony, pushing the boundaries of traditional folk-rock. This interplay not only adds depth to the sound but also captures the essence of Garside's creative vision, a blend of earthy authenticity and contemporary flair.

Garside's artistic journey has seen him evolve from a solo acoustic storyteller into a master orchestrator, weaving together complex narratives with simplicity. His inspirations run deep, Blind Faith's "Can't Find My Way Home" and Peter Gabriel's "Solsbury Hill" serve as touchstones for his musical landscape. Yet, what emerges is distinctly Garside, a voice that whispers truths through the roar of an expansive sonic environment.

The production quality of "Mariana Trench" is nothing short of extraordinary. Each instrument shines in its own light while supporting the chorus, a triumphant moment where one honest friend described it as "a burst of sunshine after the clouds move away." This description perfectly encapsulates Garside's goal: to deliver moments that uplift and heal.

Paul Garside is an alchemist who transforms troubling real-world events into compelling musical narratives. His approach to contemporary folk-rock is rooted in the traditions of classic British songwriting, but his execution places him firmly in the modern age. The warmth and organic instrumentation that define his sound are complemented by collaborative efforts from seasoned professionals like Finnish mixer Niilo Sirola.

For our readers who seek more from their musical experiences, Paul Garside's latest release offers a captivating glimpse into his world, an emotional odyssey where even the darkest depths can be transformed into an uplifting anthem.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL



The Acid Clown and His DIY Symphony



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

In the dark corners of music where grunge meets avant-garde, there exists a figure that defies categorization, Mark Garvey. With his unconventional approach to songwriting, Mark has carved out a unique niche in an industry dominated by mainstream expectations. As he unleashes his fury on a global stage with a rusty flamethrower of art, Mark seeks nothing less than the downfall of societal norms and the very fabric of existence itself.

Mark Garvey is not just another artist; he's an anomaly, an individual who takes DIY to the extreme. Strapped into one-man band mode in the shadowed recesses of his shed, Mark crafts everything from his music to films with a singular vision. The soundscapes of Mark's work are as varied and unpredictable as Garvey himself, ranging from gut-wrenching cries against systemic injustices to philosophical musings on existential despair over an underpriced latte.

Yet, the true magic lies in the way Mark's art forms transcend mere auditory experiences. Each song is but a doorway into a multimedia universe bursting with videos and artwork, each piece meticulously crafted to envelop listeners within Garvey's surreal world of critique and contemplation. It's an intimate journey that invites you to explore a cosmos where reality bends under the weight of existential dread or joyfully embraces a caffeine-induced sense of calm.

Mark's music is as abrasive as it is beautiful, a sonic mess designed to make its mark on a world that too often forgets to listen. His latest release, "The Acid Clown's Anthem," serves as a testament to his audacity and creativity. This album not only delivers the soundscapes he's known for but also expands into uncharted territories of multimedia content, each piece carefully curated to create

an immersive experience beyond traditional music.

But what truly sets Mark apart is his insistence on creating art in Adobe Premiere Pro, the very software used to edit videos. It's a testament to Garvey's self-reliance and disregard for conventional wisdom. In an age where artists often feel beholden to labels, producers, or marketing teams, Mark remains unapologetically authentic.

As he continues to push boundaries with each new creation, one can only imagine the conversations his work sparks. From the grunge revivalists who may see him as a throwback, to those exploring the depths of contemporary existentialism, Mark Garvey's music and art have already made significant ripples in the musical sea. But in a world where everything from

stream
taste
and v

SPOTLIGHT

FOREVER: The Soundtrack of Tomorrow's Dance Floors

Cosmiq and his latest release "FOREVER," continue to carve out his unique niche in the global scene, blending infectious melodies with polished production and emotive vocals to create an experience that is impossible to ignore.

"FOREVER" marks Cosmiq's commitment to a sound that seamlessly bridges modern dance music and electronic pop. The track introduces itself with an irresistible melody that immediately grabs attention, setting the stage for what will be a high-energy performance. The infectious groove pulses through each layer of production, while smooth melodic male vocals weave in effortlessly, creating a lullaby for both heads and hearts.

The standout feature is the track's memorable hook, which reappears throughout "FOREVER," ensuring it becomes an indelible part of any listener's memory. This hook not only propels the music forward but also serves as a testament to Cosmiq's knack for crafting tunes that resonate on multiple levels, musically and emotionally.

THE STORY

Cosmiq's musical identity is defined by its ability to connect instantly, whether you're standing in a club, watching festival crowds dance under the lights or cruising through your favorite

playlists. "FOREVER" exemplifies this connection by delivering a track that feels fresh yet instantly familiar, perfect for those moments when you need a little something to lift your spirits and get moving.

The track's production quality is top-notch, boasting contemporary electronic sounds fused with powerful club-ready beats. It's not just about the bass or the beats; every layer of the music is meticulously crafted to ensure it feels both modern yet timeless. The result is an anthemic experience that captures the feeling of freedom, connection and celebration.

Cosmiq has been honing his craft for years, always pushing boundaries in terms of what modern dance music can be. From his earliest releases to "FOREVER," he's consistently pushed forward, incorporating new elements while maintaining a recognizable signature sound. This balance, of staying fresh yet rooted in tradition, is precisely why Cosmiq stands out.

In an industry where trends come and go like the seasons, finding a consistent point of connection with listeners is no small feat. "FOREVER" not only meets this challenge but elevates it to new heights. It's more than just another dance track; it's part of a larger conversation about what music can do, how it can make you feel and why it matters.

In the ever-evolving landscape of electronic music, Cosmiq is not only charting his own path but also setting new standards for what modern dance anthems should be. "FOREVER" encapsulates all that makes him a standout artist: energetic, melodic and deeply connected to his listeners.

Cosmiq's journey thus far has been one marked by innovation and authenticity. With each release, he continues to refine his sound, always staying true to his creative vision and emotional depth. "FOREVER" stands as testament to Cosmiq's enduring commitment to creating music that feels both new and familiar, music that connects you on a deep level.

As we move into the future, one thing is clear: Cosmiq is an artist whose sound will resonate with generations to come. His signature blend of modern energy, melodic sensibilities, and powerful production continues to set him apart in the ever-evolving world of electronic music. And as "FOREVER" sweeps across playlists and clubs alike, it's hard not to see a future where Cosmiq's name becomes synonymous with some of the most unforgettable dance anthems.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL



DEEP DIVE

Power Up Tonight: Neon Nights and Rolling Rhythms



Andrei British has found his musical South Florida. With "Power Up," the Miami-born artist crafts an electrifying track that captures the pulse of after-dark nightlife in vibrant hues of neon and raw energy.

British's latest single, "South Florida Police," is a snapshot of life beneath the city lights. It's the soundtrack to those moments when the sun dips below the horizon, casting an eerie glow over streets where people dance with abandon under the cover of night.

With "Power Up," British turns the tables, inviting listeners into a world where neon-lit roads pulse with excitement. The track is a masterclass in capturing the frenetic pace of South Florida after dark, blending classic rock's raw energy with the modern flair that defines the city.

"I wanted it to feel like South Florida nightlife actually feels to me," British explains. "There's movement everywhere, cars, lights, music, people going out, flirting, looking for something to happen." His descriptions evoke a scene where every detail plays into the song's energetic flow: from the hum of engines to the shimmering reflections off windows.

The track is propelled by an ebullient boogie-woogie riff, which British describes as embodying the city's nightlife spirit. The lyrics paint a vivid picture, evoking scenes where people are cruising slowly through bustling streets, doors opened wide, windows down, letting their guard down to catch glimpses of what awaits beyond.

"Power Up!" becomes more than just a catchy chorus; it encapsulates the joy and excitement of exploring South Florida at night. British's lyrics touch on

moments of flirtation, anticipation, and the thrill of being out and about in an environment where anything can happen.

"I wanted it to feel like South Florida nightlife actually feels to me," British explains."

In "South Florida Police," British dives deep into his personal experience as a native born and raised Floridian who has witnessed firsthand the city come alive after dark. The song captures the essence of South Florida nightlife through the eyes of those who call it home, making it feel both universal and uniquely specific.

By juxtaposing these two tracks, "South Florida Police" and "Power Up Tonight", British presents a dual portrait of his musical South Florida: one by the people who come out to own South Florida streets after dark. These songs celebrate not just the physical act of going out, but also the emotional journey that follows, the thrill of discovery, the promise of adventure, and the joy of letting go.

As British's music continues to evolve, he remains true to his roots while embracing new sounds and perspectives. "Power Up Tonight" marks another step in this ongoing exploration, offering fans an intimate glimpse into a world where boogie woogie rhythms blend seamlessly with the modern pulse of South Florida's nightlife.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

THE CHILD'S CRY: ROGER K'S DARK-POP JOURNEY



Roger K has a new single, "Please Don't Put It on Me," which is a hauntingly beautiful reflection of childhood trauma and its lifelong repercussions. From the perspective of an innocent child, the song captures the immense weight that falls upon their shoulders.

The song begins with Roger contemplating adults who find themselves behind bars, reflecting on how often children bear the consequences of adult decisions. This introspection sets the stage for a larger exploration: what if an adult had listened earlier? From expectations within our own homes to academic, cultural and financial pressures, detention, political conflict, and war, children inherit these burdens.

The narrative shifts from the child's perspective to Roger's as he voices words that have long been unsaid. "Please don't put it on me / Don't you know I can't breathe / All this weight controls me / Let my spirit be free." Despite its haunting melody, there is a glimmer of hope within Roger's plea. Speaking out is itself an act of defiance and hope, a chance for adults to finally listen.

Musically, "Please Don't Put It On Me" combines cinematic orchestration with a spacious darkness. The track marries alternative R&B, soulful pop vocals, and a trap/drill-influenced rhythmic foundation, reminiscent of Labrinth's theatrical scale, Jacob Banks' atmospheric weight, and the vulnerable soul-pop delivery of Sam Smith.

Roger wrote, arranged, performed, produced, mixed, and mastered the entire record himself. His self-directed approach infuses an unparalleled sense of control into his work. This level of artistic independence sets Roger K apart in a landscape dominated by industry collaborations and corporate oversight.

The accompanying animated visualizer draws inspiration from Banksy's public works, reimagining imagery associated with authority, violence, displacement, and adult conflict. Each frame is carefully crafted to paint a continuous story of children encountering these themes, creating a poignant commentary on childhood trauma's far-reaching impact.

Roger K stands as an independent pop artist whose modern commercial sound seamlessly blends subtle R&B influences. His music feels immediate, confident, and emotionally resonant, qualities that have earned him over 15 years of live performance experience across Australia's eastern seaboard. With audiences regularly exceeding 300 people and a catalog of more than 150 gigs under his belt, Roger K has solidified himself as a formidable presence in the industry.

With each note, Roger K not only honors the voices lost to time but also calls upon adults to take responsibility for their own actions. "Please Don't Put It On Me" is an unyielding plea and a testament to the power of art to break down barriers and encourage empathy.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

PROFILE

A Song of Unimagined Hope: M & J's "Not a Love Song"

Meet M & J and their new song, "Not a Love Song".

The track is basically an intimate story about unrequited love, expectations, and the space between what someone hopes a relationship could become and what it actually becomes. Written from a personal experience of one half of M & J, the song originally began with a simple intention: to write a love song for someone they had met and genuinely cared about.

But as the relationship unfolded, it became clear that the feelings were not equally shared. The intentions shifted and evolved into something more reflective, a story about the dreams, hopes, and imagined possibilities attached to a relationship that never materialized in the way they had hoped. In that sense, "Not a Love Song" became exactly what its title suggests. It isn't a traditional love song about two people finding each other. It is about wanting something, imagining what it could be, and accepting that sometimes the story in your head isn't the story life gives you.

For M & J, the song captures the uncomfortable truth that sometimes, no matter what someone does, another person simply won't feel the same way. And sometimes, that truth is the story worth singing.

M & J's musical journey is as intricate and multifaceted as their lyrical content. With a blend of smooth melodies and harmonies, they weave together a tapestry of emotions, from heartache to longing to acceptance. Their sound is both familiar and unique, resonating with

listeners who are drawn into the intimate world they create.

One cannot discuss M & J without acknowledging their production quality. Each track feels meticulously crafted, with every instrument layered with care to create a rich sonic landscape that allows each line of lyrics to breathe. The harmonies in particular stand out, serving as both a backdrop for storytelling and a focal point of emotional depth.

M & J's creative vision is a testament to the power of vulnerability in music. In an industry often dominated by surface-level narratives, they offer something far more profound, honest reflections on complex emotions that resonate beyond mere personal experiences. They invite us into their world, where we find ourselves questioning our own expectations and desires.

One standout moment from this journey comes with their latest release titled "Not a Love Song." Here, M & J not only explore the unfulfilled potential of love but also delve into other aspects of relationships that often fly under the radar. Through this song, they touch on themes like trust, communication, and ultimately, acceptance, emotions that are as universal as they are elusive.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL



Few artists blend contemporary sounds with such depth and gravity as ZeeCogency. Hailing from Sydney, this project has been quietly shaping its sound for over two decades, exploring every genre from hip hop to metal without ever losing touch with the rhythmic core that defines it all.

ZeeCogency's music is a tapestry of influences woven into an electronic fabric, ranging from downtempo's subtle textures and trip-hop's cinematic elements to the weighty beats of big beat and experimental electronica. This synthesis creates a unique sonic palette that is both expansive and grounded, offering listeners a space to dance while contemplating life.

THE STORY

On their latest release, "So Easy," ZeeCogency delivers a track that sits comfortably at the more accessible end of their project's spectrum. With its laid-back yet atmospheric vibe, it showcases their ability to craft music with strong groove and bass-heavy production, a testament to their ongoing commitment to electronic music as a medium for movement and emotion.

This latest release is part of ZeeCogency's broader vision: creating immersive electronic music that invites listeners into a world where space, darkness, and atmosphere coexist alongside a rhythmic heart. It's this willingness to blend disparate influences, such as the weighty beats of hip hop, the repetition-driven energy of dance music, and the textural experimentation typical of trip-hop, with live instrumentation like guitar and bass, that sets ZeeCogency apart.

The artist's approach is not one of strict genre adherence but rather a celebration of electronic elements within a diverse sonic landscape. Each track begins with a rhythm, bass line, or texture before unfolding organically to create something fresh and organic. This method ensures that while the music may seem distant from its inspirations, it remains intrinsically connected to its roots through a rhythmic foundation.

In an era where electronic music often feels like a sterile pursuit of sound effects and beats without much emotional depth, ZeeCogency stands out as a beacon of creativity. Their latest release, "So Easy," is not just a glimpse into the future but also a reminder that even in the digital age, there's power in rhythm and groove, power to move bodies and souls.

For our readers that seek music that dances between dark shadows and cosmic expanses, ZeeCogency's work offers both an exploration of genre boundaries and a deep appreciation for electronic music as a living, breathing art form. Their journey from Sydney to the world stage is one of continuous evolution and fusion, creating a sound that resonates with every listener who seeks more than just beats, someone seeking a deeper connection through movement, mood, and melody.

ZEECOGENCY BLENDS ELECTRONIC DREAMS AND DARK BEATS"



Z E E C O G E N C Y





Lyndo Jaco



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

THE MELODIC MAVERICK OF ROCK

A hidden gem in the heart of Happy Valley, South Australia, Lyndo Jaco crafts his music with an intimate touch and a defiant spirit. As a lone figure tinkering away in his home studio, Jaco weaves together his multifaceted talents, playing guitar, bass, drums, and singing, to create a sonic tapestry that is as unique as it is compelling.

From the moment he picks up his instruments, Lyndo Jaco's creativity erupts. His rock arrangements are not just notes on a page but a raw expression of emotion, often steeped in storytelling. Each track pulses with a distinct narrative, each song an emotional journey through dark alleys and sunlit vistas. The result is music that feels both personal and universal, intimate confessions interwoven into the grandest symphonies.

Lyndo Jaco's sonic palette is as varied as it is masterful. From his nimble guitar work to his deft drumming, every instrument serves a purpose in supporting his voice. The way he layers sounds with precision speaks volumes about his understanding of production quality and emotional depth. His latest effort, the EP "3," exemplifies this approach: each song feels like a complete world unto itself, built around an evocative melody that invites listeners to dip their toes into Jaco's creative landscape.

What makes Lyndo Jaco distinctive is not just his musical prowess but also his unapologetic approach. He eschews the mainstream for a more authentic sound, one that resonates deeply with those who seek something raw and unrestrained in their music. In an era where sound design often dictates what we hear, Jaco prioritizes emotion over effect, crafting tunes that are at once technical marvels and heartfelt confessions.

In his latest release, "3," Jaco continues to explore the boundaries of rock without losing sight of its core essence. With each new track, he builds on his foundation with layers of instrumentation, dynamics, and narrative depth, creating a sonic journey that is as captivating as it is enlightening. Whether you're drawn in by his storytelling prowess or simply mesmerized by his musicianship, Lyndo Jaco's music will leave you feeling both understood and inspired.

For those eager to dive into his world, the EP "3" offers an immersive experience, a testament to what happens when one person combines their entire life's worth of influences, experiences, and creativity into a singular artistic vision. As this recluse continues to craft his sound in secret, it's clear that he has much more to share with the world.



Noel Johnson NDJ's "Lord Look After Me"



Noel Johnson NDJ and his latest single, "Lord Look After Me," released on September 8th, is a dark anthem that drives through the empty, smoldering desert of modern despair.

Johnson describes "Lord Look After Me" as an urgent plea from a soul lost in the badlands of life. The track's hauntingly beautiful vocals sit atop unusual instrumental choices, drums recorded one strike at a time using hands and atypical tools, layered beneath swirling echo

effects that mimic the desert's perpetual murkiness. This unique sonic palette blends southern gospel-inspired harmonies with eerie, soulful undertones, creating a space where hymn and despair coexist in uneasy harmony.

Johnson's creative vision is as meticulously crafted as it is rawly personal. His artistic identity is steeped in old gospel traditions, yet he pushes the boundaries of what those sounds can achieve. He channels the spirit of iconoclasts like Tom Waits, Leonard Cohen, Nina Simone, Fleet

Foxes, and Beck, crafting a sound that feels both timeless and unapologetically contemporary.

Recording in the windowless basement of an old church while building his home studio, Johnson's work embodies a state of isolation. This intimate space, where sacred and profane bleed into one another, provides the perfect backdrop for exploring the darker corners of the human experience with vulnerability and defiant grace.

"Johnson's creative vision is as meticulously crafted as it is rawly personal."

As Noel Johnson NDJ is moving towards an album release in early 2027, he sets himself apart as an artist unafraid to delve into the most profound aspects of the human condition: doubt,

faith, and the eternal search for comfort when understanding feels impossibly distant.

In a world where music often seeks refuge in joyous melodies, Noel Johnson NDJ offers a

hauntingly beautiful song that beckons listeners into a sacred yet sorrowful space. "Lord Look After Me" is a track not just for those who are lost but also for the ones searching for hope amidst desolation.

DEFLECTING GHOSTS



SURVIVING SHADOWS: DEFLECTING GHOSTS UNEARTH THE DARK SIDE OF MODERN METAL

The Kansas-based alternative metal trio Deflecting Ghosts, has a new track "Narcissist" which captures the raw, cathartic essence of what it means to face one's inner demons head-on.

Driven by Luke Fitzgerald on vocals and guitar, alongside bassist Rhema Fitzgerald and drummer Jeremy Burnett, this band weaves together the heavy riffs and melodic hooks of modern hard rock with a depth of emotion that sets them apart. Their debut release, "Narcissist," is a brutal testament to the psychological scars left by toxic relationships, a dark, aggressive alternative metal track built around a moment when you finally recognize someone for who they are, and refuse to let them control your narrative.

"Narcissist" was mixed and mastered by Bulletride Productions, a hallmark of Deflecting Ghosts' consistent quality in sound. This single represents another step forward in the band's evolving sound, which has built upon influences like Chevelle, Cold, Breaking Benjamin, Bad Omens, and Bring Me The Horizon.

Deflecting Ghosts' journey is one marked by resilience. They've surpassed 220,000 streams, reached listeners across nearly 150 countries, and garnered a growing

social following of more than 85,000 fans while continuing to expand their reach through regional shows and festival appearances.

What makes Deflecting Ghosts distinctive is their ability to take the heaviest of metal sounds and infuse them with real-world narratives, stories that are as personal as they are universal. Songs like "Narcissist" explore themes of addiction, grief, mental health, redemption, faith, perseverance, and the relentless fight against life's darkest moments.

Their live performances are a testament to their songwriting strength. They combine precision, energy, and emotional authenticity, making each show not just another performance but a deeply personal experience for audiences. In 2026, during Luke's battle with severe heart failure, Deflecting Ghosts performed a grueling 12-hour drive from Hutchinson to Sturgis, South Dakota, at the iconic Sturgis Motorcycle Rally, a moment that underscores their enduring spirit and commitment to their craft.

Deflecting Ghosts' music isn't merely escapism; it's survival. They face the ghosts of addiction, grief, and mental

health head-on in songs like "Narcissist," while others tackle themes such as redemption and faith. Their dedication is mirrored in their consistent releases, planned every 4-6 weeks, and in the raw emotion that resonates through each track.

The band's strength lies not just in their sound or performances, but in the stories they tell. They embody the belief that sometimes surviving is the most powerful thing a person can do. Their influence has been felt by fans and critics alike, with Deflecting Ghosts recognized by multiple music publications for their raw honesty and unapologetic authenticity.

As they continue to evolve, Deflecting Ghosts remains committed to sharing their survival stories through the cathartic power of metal. For those who need music in its most powerful form, there are few bands as essential or compelling as Deflecting Ghosts.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL



A BAND'S JOURNEY THROUGH DIGITAL DISCONNECT

John Muka Band's new single "Bus Stop" feels more relevant than ever. Originally penned at the dawn of the 21st century amidst the turmoil of 9/11, the song encapsulates a timeless sentiment: our relentless quest for genuine human connection in an era saturated by digital connectivity.

The John Muka Band, fronted by vocalist and songwriter John Muka, has crafted a sound that balances indie rock's edgy rawness with Americana's heartfelt sincerity. Their latest single, "More & More," is a testament to their collaborative spirit, showcasing vibrant rhythms and feel-good melodies that resonate with listeners and playlist curators alike.

Musically, the band weaves together indie rock's grittiness, jam-band energy, soulful grooves, and layered Americana into a sound both timelessly authentic and refreshingly contemporary. Their latest single, "Bus Stop," reflects their love for organic performances, rooted in real musicians playing live in the room.

The John Muka Band's discography is a testament to their ability to move effortlessly between uplifting grooves and reflective storytelling. With a new release on the horizon, they continue to expand their audience while maintaining an authentic connection with fans through streaming platforms, live shows, playlist support, and independent music media outreach.

THE STORY

In 2001, the world was rocked by the twin towers tragedy of September 11. Amidst this unprecedented shock and disconnection, John Muka penned "Bus Stop," a song that would resonate long after its initial release. Now, nearly three decades later, it feels increasingly relevant in our own era marked by technological connectivity yet palpable lack of genuine human interaction.

The John Muka Band's blend of indie rock, Americana, and jam-band influences is underscored by their commitment to crafting music with organic, live-band feel that stands apart from polished studio productions. Their performances often showcase a rich multi-instrumental lineup featuring horns, violin, percussion, dual guitars, and even the occasional horn section.

"Bus Stop" serves as an ode to real human connection in a world where we are increasingly connected through screens but struggle to find authentic interactions outside of digital realms. With its blend of indie rock's raw energy and Americana's heartfelt storytelling, "Bus Stop" is both a balm for our times and a testament to the John Muka Band's singular artistic vision.

The John Muka Band draws inspiration from classic jam acts like Phish, Grateful Dead, and Jack White, among others. This blend of influences informs their dynamic live performances that often feature horn sections, violinists, percussionists, and dual guitars. Their music is as much at home on festival stages as it is in indie playlists or during late-night drives.

Their latest single, "More & More," captures the band's collaborative spirit with infectious melodies and vibrant rhythms. Yet, their live shows are a testament to authentic musical chemistry, a shared stage where every note and movement comes from an unfiltered connection between musicians and audience alike.

The John Muka Band's journey is one of growth and expansion. With plans for more releases throughout 2026 including "Bus Stop," they remain grounded in their roots while reaching new audiences through streaming platforms, live shows, playlist support, and independent media outreach. Their unique blend of influences resonates deeply with fans who seek music that bridges digital disconnection with genuine human connection.

The John Muka Band's legacy is built on the promise of genuine human connection in a world increasingly defined by technological connectivity. From their earliest days, they have crafted music that speaks to this timeless need for connection, a desire that remains just as vital today, if not more so given our current digital landscape.

As 2026 approaches and new releases like "Bus Stop" are released into the world, the John Muka Band continues to build momentum. Their ability to blend classic influences with contemporary sensibilities ensures their music will remain relevant for years to come, a testament to both their enduring artistic vision and our ongoing need for genuine human connection in an increasingly connected world.

FEATURE

"SUNSET CHILL: DJ JON'S BALEARIC REVIVAL"

Africa - Chill Mix by DJ Jon is more than just a remix, it's a journey through time and space, reimagining Toto's "Africa" with Balearic flair that captures the essence of Ibiza's legendary summer chill vibes. Released on August 28th, this single from WhiteLab Music not only pushes the boundaries of electronic music but also pays homage to its roots. Recorded at the illustrious WhiteLab Music studio in Essex, DJ Jon has crafted a production so meticulously detailed and emotionally resonant that it feels like stepping into an Ibiza sunset.

The track begins with Toto's signature keyboard melody, one that conjures memories of dancing under starlit skies on sandy beaches. DJ Jon's version takes this iconic song, a love story as universal as the sun, into a new dimension, layering it with smooth emotive pads and meandering Spanish guitar. The magic happens when

Whitney Breanne's silky soul vocals emerge from the mix; her delivery is both timeless and modern, weaving through the beats to create an almost live experience.

What sets "Africa - Chill Mix" apart isn't just its production quality but the creative vision behind it. DJ Jon has assembled a team of collaborators, Whitney Breanne for her emotive vocals and a skilled session musician for his Latin-infused acoustic guitar work, to bring this project to life. The blend of electronic production expertise with live instrumentation showcases DJ Jon's ability to seamlessly fuse contemporary electronic music with organic, emotive elements.

Beyond the studio, DJ Jon's live performances have established him as a respected figure in the electronic music scene. From regular gigs across Essex and the wider UK, he consistently delivers high-

quality experiences that resonate deeply with his audience. His distinctive sound has earned him praise from industry heavyweights like Quintessential Records ("a fantastic remix") and Project Dee ("beautiful, fresh Summer vibes").

In an era where remixed versions of classic tracks often fall flat, DJ Jon's "Africa - Chill Mix" stands out as a true contemporary masterpiece. It's not just about keeping the music moving; it's about capturing the essence of those summer nights when love seemed both timeless and forever new.

For our readers seeking a dive into this unique blend of Balearic beats, emotive melodies, and soulful vocals, "Africa - Chill Mix" is DJ Jon's invitation to lose themselves in the sun-drenched reverie. As listeners tune in, they're not just listening to music, they're joining an auditory journey through time and space.



AFRICA



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